concepts. While our concepts, involving the association of names and general properties with the given, do not copy the fluid play of the real particulars, they represent it indirectly. We cannot directly know reality as it is in itself because we are primarily aware of images derived form sensory impressions.

Dharmakirti says that the activity of conceptual construction (***kalpana***) is cognition involving a representation that is capable of being expressed in words. Once an aspect of reality has been mentally discriminated (***adhyavasaya***), we can act in relation to it. Sense perception on its own has no practical application because it does not discriminate anything. Judgements using concepts lead to successful activity when they are causally related to real particulars. But it is a natural mistake to suppose that our concepts are copies of reality. Error occurs when we think that our representations stand for reality as it is in itself.

See ***grahya-grahaka-vibhaga***

Further reading: Dunne 2004; Kajiyama 1998; Mookerjee 1975; Prasad 2002; Stcherbatsky 1993; Tillemans 1999

Dharmakirti on perception: *Dharmakirti* says that true cognition is the presupposition of all successful human activity. The reliable means of knowledge (***pramana***) is true cognition relating to an object not already known. It is twofold: direct perception and inference. Perception is free from conceptualisation (***kalpana***) and is reliable (***abhranta***). He rejects ***Dignaga***'s view that thought and language always go together and claims that thought is prior to language: conceptualisation is a cognition involving a representation (*pratibhasa*) that is *capable* of linguistic expression.

Perception is fourfold: sensory impressions; a mental image produced from the sensory impressions that are its immediately preceding cause; the self-awareness of every